two senior partners of his father's old firm upset him greatly. It was then that Vijbhucandas suggested gently that he needed young men in his firm and it would do him no harm to join the business. In 1901, Purshotamdas joined his uncle's firm Narandas Rajaram and Co. as an apprentice. For the next three years he learnt the business and what Purshotamdas lacked in experience he made up by his tireless industry, quick mastering of facts, and his ability to see all round as well as into a problem. When Vijbhucandas was stricken by an illness which virtually immobilized him, Purshotamdas joined the firm as an eight-anna partner. He used his patrimony to wipe out a part of the firm's losses of the previous year incurred in the oilseeds section.

As a senior partner, Purshotamdas soon made his presence felt. The integrity for which he would become famous and justly honoured later in his career, was soon on display. Purshotamdas discovered that inferior varieties of cotton were mixed with superior varieties to shore up profits. He put a stop to this practice despite the skepticism in trade circles about the lack of pragmatism of such a display of virtue. The pundits of the industry prophesied ruin since according to them Purshotamdas's cotton would soon be priced out of the market. Nothing of that sort happened. In this case, honesty did turn out to be the best policy and Purshotamdas's stock soared. His reputation for honest dealing reached the ears of E.E. Sassoon and led to the incident narrated earlier.

A few years later, in 1911, Purshotamdas made his debut in public service through the instrumentality of no less a personage than Sir Pherozeshah Mehta, the Uncrowned King of Bombay, then at the height of his civic fame. In 1911, a local famine struck Gujarat, in particular the areas of Kutch and Kathiawar. In Bombay, aid was being mobilized by Sir Pherozeshah, and he was looking for a suitable secretary for the Relief Fund. Reports of Purshotamdas's abilities had reached Sir Pherozeshah and he offered him the post. Sir Pherozeshah knew Vijbhucandas well and was delighted to learn that Purshotamdas was his nephew. Purshotamdas accepted after initial hesitation. He worked feverishly for famine alleviation for almost a year, working for as much as 14-15 hours a day. His efforts were recognized not only by the Committee of the Fund but also by Sir George Clarke who recommended him for the Kaiser-i-Hind silver medal, which Sir Pherozeshah's felt was far too meager recognition for his